

SQUADRON LEADER

SARNISH KOUR

(Retd.)

| Brand Strategy
| Business Development
| Strategic Operations
| Global Partnerships

CONTACT

sarnish.kour@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/sarnish-kour
sarnishkour.github.io

CORE COMPETENCIES

- ▸ Business Development & Market Expansion
- ▸ Brand Strategy & Digital Outreach
- ▸ Global Partnerships & Stakeholder Management
- ▸ Strategic Operations & Governance
- ▸ Enrolment Operations & CRM Excellence
- ▸ Change Management & Transformation
- ▸ Vendor, Agency & Partner Management
- ▸ Risk Management & Quality Assurance

CERTIFICATIONS & RECOGNITION

- ▸ **Commendation — AOC-in-Chief, IAF** Indigenous fabrication of combat-critical equipment
- ▸ **1st in Order of Merit — Professional Knowledge Course** Air Force Technical College
- ▸ **1st in Course — Missile Technical Training, IAF**
- ▸ **Lean Six Sigma Green Belt** KPMG
- ▸ **Certified QA Inspector** Aeronautical Equipment
- ▸ **Certified Internal Auditor ISO 9001:2015** BEQI
- ▸ **Leading High Performing Teams** Willis Towers Watson
- ▸ **ILM Operational Development Programme** OEE Consulting Limited

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Multi-domain leader with 17+ years spanning defence operations, global management consulting, and institutional strategy. Commissioned officer of the Indian Air Force; Operations Manager at Willis Towers Watson serving Fortune 500 clients across the US & UK Lines of Business; and strategic operations head at one of India's premier engineering institutions, driving enrolment, brand, institutional accreditation, and cross-border engagements across 7 countries. Combines military execution discipline, consulting rigour, and a global professional network. An advocate of excellence, diverse perspectives, and respect for all.

CAREER IMPACT HIGHLIGHTS

₹32 Cr	Savings to exchequer via indigenous fabrication of defence equipment (IAF)	**1st**	Full university globally to receive the BSIS Impact Label (EFMD Global)
3X 1st	Growth in client portfolio at WTW within one year; team attrition reduced from 28% to near zero	**7**	Countries engaged through international engagements & research (Japan, Portugal, Finland, Switzerland, Denmark, UAE, USA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head – Brand Strategy, Communications & Operations | **TIET, Patiala**
May 2022 – Present

Official designation: Head – Marketing & Admissions | Scope: Premier engineering & management institution | Reported to Vice Chancellor | Cross-functional leadership across brand, outreach, enrolment, international programmes & accreditation

Brand Strategy & Communications

- Architected institution-wide brand strategy, repositioning TIET nationally through integrated communications across digital, print, events, and industry forums
- Led digital outreach and expansion: social media ecosystem, content pipeline, and digital marketing operations across UG, PG, and international programmes
- Led FICCI engagement and thought-leadership positioning, representing TIET in high-visibility national industry forums

Business Development & Market Expansion

- Built new business development infrastructure: established two regional outreach offices (Dehradun & Amritsar) with CRM backbone and agency/channel-partner networks
- Built Japan engagement: MoU with MMRI and initial engagement with JETRO; led student delegation (7 international students) to Japan for sustainability course and cultural immersion, opening bilateral exchange
- Represented institution at MARIHE Consortium meetings in Porto (Portugal) and Finland; managed full international student lifecycle from curriculum to country immersion
- Delivered the BSIS Impact Label — two-year EFMD Global/FNEGE accreditation initiative — making TIET the first full university globally to receive the label

Admissions Operations & Governance

- Deployed and managed multiple CRM systems across the full enrolment lifecycle — lead generation, tele-calling operations, examination, selection, and conversion; set up and scaled pan-India tele-calling infrastructure with measurable enrolment impact
- Managed accreditation strategy and national/international rankings — delivering measurable improvement in institutional standing

Operations Manager – Actuarial Valuations | **Willis Towers Watson GDS Pvt. Ltd., Mumbai**
July 2018 – January 2021

Scope: Fortune 500 client portfolio | US & UK stakeholder management | Offshore team built from ground up | Selected from 180 candidates at PRCs at IIM

- Built and stabilised WTW's offshore actuarial pension valuation operations in Mumbai from zero with operational frameworks, workflow management, QC systems, and performance systems
- Grew client portfolio by 3X within the first year; consistently delivered high "Voice of Business Partner" scores from US and UK stakeholders
- Reduced team attrition from 28% to near zero through structured performance measurement, Route to Competency model, and succession planning

TEACHING & WORKSHOPS

- **Organisational Change & Development** TSLAS, TIET · 6th Semester HRM
- **ICC Member — POSH Trained** Workplace Grievance & Compliance
- **HOBO Robotic Vehicle Training** Workshops for air warriors & officers from WAC squadrons at BRD

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

- **AOM Best Paper Proceedings 2023:** *AOM 2023 at Boston – Impact Opportunity Development in Social Ventures*
- Social Entrepreneurship Annual Conference 2024 at IMD Lausanne
- USASBE Doctoral Consortium 2024
- AOM 2025 at Copenhagen – Paper Presentation and Doctoral Consortium

LANGUAGES

- English
- Hindi
- Punjabi
- Dogri
- German (Basic)

INTERESTS

- Meditation & Spiritual Wellbeing
- Reading & Research
- Networking & Mentoring
- Writing (Poetry & Academic)
- Walking in Solitude

Squadron Leader – Technical Officer (Air Defence & Missile Systems) | **Indian Air Force**
July 2008 – July 2018

Scope: Decade of commissioned service | Air Defence operations | Supply chain for two Surface-to-Air missile systems | BRD production operations | Led ~500 personnel

- Spearheaded Air Defence operations and strategic deployments — including military train movement for live missile firing on eastern coast and other ranges
- As Senior Production Engineer at Base Repair Depot (BRD): managed end-to-end production lifecycle for missile system overhauls — turnaround time optimisation, resource utilisation, throughput management, and QA
- Directed supply chain management for two Surface-to-Air missile systems — procurement, indigenisation, and vendor co-ordination with Russian and Ukrainian associates
- Engineered ₹32 Crore savings to the exchequer: led indigenous fabrication with Indian vendor at ₹8 Crore — landmark in strategic sourcing and import substitution
- Member of IAF Innovation Display Team: presented to President of India and Defence Minister on Air Force Day; recognised by Air HQ for recovery of combat-critical equipment
- Commanded and trained air warriors; managed workshops, appraisals, promotion, and grievance handling

EDUCATION

PhD (Pursuing) – Management (ENT) | LM Thapar School of Management, TIET
Thesis: Impact Opportunity Development in Social Ventures | AOM Best Paper Proceedings 2023 | Presented at AOM Boston, IMD Lausanne, USASBE Doctoral Consortium, AOM Copenhagen | AACSB Accredited
Residential Course in Business Management (6 months) | IIM Indore
MBA (HR) | IGNOU
MS (Software Systems) — M.Tech. equivalent | BITS Pilani
PG Diploma in Aeronautical Engineering | AFTC, Bangalore & VTU, Belgaum
B.E. (IT) | Jammu University

INTERNATIONAL ENGAGEMENTS

AOM Annual Conference (Boston 2023; Copenhagen 2025)
MaRIHE Consortium (Porto 2025; Finland 2023)
UAE (Market outreach, 2024)
Japan (MMRI MoU and student delegation, 2024; JETRO engagement, 2025)
IMD Lausanne, Switzerland (Social Entrepreneurship Conference, 2024)